



CALICUT UNIVERSITY – FOUR-YEAR UNDERGRADUATE PROGRAMME (CU-FYUGP)

BA ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE HONOURS

BASKET 1: LITERATURE AND INDIAN SOCIETY

Programme	BA ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE HONOURS				
Course Code	ENG5EJ302(1)				
Course Title	INDIAN AESTHETICS: AN INTRODUCTION				
Type of Course	ELECTIVE				
Semester	5				
Academic Level	300-399				
Course Details	Credit	Lecture per week	Tutorial per week	Practical per week	Total Hours
	4	4	-	-	60
Pre-requisites	Basic Understanding of Indian literary terms with an aptitude for Indian thought				
Course Summary	This course explores the tradition of Indian literary theory, focusing on Sanskrit aesthetics and its key concepts. It delves into, the role of the poet and reader, and the different schools of thought that have shaped Indian literary criticism for centuries. The course will then give an overview of the impact of Western concepts and contemporary approaches to Indian aesthetics.				

Course Outcomes (CO):

CO	CO Statement	Cognitive Level*	*Knowledge Category	Evaluation Tools used
CO1	Gain a comprehensive understanding of the historic development of Indian aesthetics	U	C	Exam/ Assignment/ Presentations/ workshops/ interactive sessions
CO2	Analyze key concepts such as Rasa, Dhvani, Alankara, and Auchitya.	Ap	P	Translation assignments/ workshops/
CO3	Understand the role of the poet (Kavi) and the ideal reader (Sahridaya).	U	C	Presentations/ reviews/ case studies
CO4	Evaluate the development of Indian literary theory through different schools of thought.	E	C, P	Software demonstrations/ practical and digital presentations
CO5	Explore the influence of Western ideas and contemporary critiques on Indian aesthetics	U	C, P	Translation practice and public presentations in various genres and fields of verbal, visual and print sectors
CO6	Enhance the ability to identify and appreciate art and literature based on the aesthetic principles and elements	E, U	M	Innovative research productivity through independent research
* - Remember (R), Understand (U), Apply (Ap), Analyse (An), Evaluate (E), Create (C) # - Factual Knowledge (F) Conceptual Knowledge (C) Procedural Knowledge (P) Metacognitive Knowledge (M)				

Detailed Syllabus:

MODULE	UNIT	CONTENT	Hrs	Marks70
I		Introduction	12	16
	1	Literature and Aesthetic Philosophy	4	
	2	Key Concepts- Kavi- Kavyam- Sahridayan- Sahitya	3	
	3	Nipunata, Pratibha - Karaitri , Bhavayitri	2	
	4	Introducing Dravidian Aesthetic concepts- Tinai- Ainthinai- Meyyad/Meythal, Ullurai- Uvaman	3	
		Suggested Activities: 1. Analyze a poem or artwork using the discussed concepts. Identify elements of Sahitya, the role of the Sahridayan, and how the artist employs Kavi Kriya. 2. Discuss the relationship between Indian aesthetics and specific philosophical schools (e. g., Rasa theory and Hinduism). 3. Create a short piece of writing (poem, story) keeping the principles of Indian aesthetics in mind		
II		Pre-Dhvani Schools and Theories leading up to Thvani	12	19
	5	The Alankara School- Evolution- Strength and Limitations	3	
	6	Riti and Guna schools - Riti and style- Evolution	3	
	7	Rasa school- Definition and Evolution	2	
	8	Dhvani and its centrality in literary experience	2	
	9	Sabdarthavyaparam- Classifications of Dhvani- Abhinava Gupta	2	

		Suggested Reading: Debate on the topic: 1. "Alankara emphasizes the beauty and creativity of language in poetry." 2. Research and present on a famous poet associated with a specific Riti or Guna 3. Read and discuss poems that evoke different rasas (eg, shringar – love, veer – heroism)		
III	Post-Dhvani Developments		12	19
	10	Gunibhutavyangya- Chitrakavya and its critique of Dhvani theory	3	
	11	The Vakrokti School- classification, Vakrokti and style- Anumiti	3	
	12	Theory of Anumana	2	
	13	The Aucitya School- Aucitya and its significance	2	
	14	Kavi siksha- Creative Expression	2	
		Suggested Reading: 1. Divide the class and hold a debate on the following: "Is Gunibhutavyangya (implicit suggestion) superior to other forms of suggestion in literary work." 2. Comparative Analysis: Select a poem from a renowned Dhvani poet (eg, Anandavardhana) and another poem from the Chitrakavya school (eg, Vagbhata). Analyze how each poem approaches language and imagery, highlighting the focus on suggestion (Dhvani) vs. the beauty of expression (Chitrakavya). 3. Group Discussion: Discuss the strengths and limitations of the Dhvani theory. Consider questions like: Does Dhvani overemphasize the suggested meaning at the expense of the literal meaning? Is there a place for both aspects in creating a successful literary work?		

IV	Colonialism and after		12	16
	15	The impact of Western literary concepts on Indian aesthetics	3	
	16	Arvind Ghosh and Rabindranath Tagore	3	
	17	Reinterpretations of Indian aesthetics in the colonial context	3	
	18	Contemporary Approaches: Dalit and Feminist critiques of traditional aesthetics	3	
		Suggested Reading: 1. Prepare short biographies of Tagore and Aravindo and share it in the class. 2. Organise a group discussion on how feminist thought approaches traditional aesthetics. 3. Write an assignment on the topic "Colonialism and the emergence of oriental studies in India".		
V	OPEN ENDED		12	

Note: The course is divided into five modules, with four having total 18 fixed units and one open-ended module with a variable number of units. There are total 48 instructional hours for the fixed modules and 12 hours for the open-ended one. Internal assessments (30 marks) are split between the open-ended module (10 marks) and the fixed modules (20 marks). The final exam, however, covers only the 18 units from the fixed modules.

Suggested Reading:

1. Indian Literary Criticism:
2. Theory And Interpretation - G.N.Devi
3. *Sanskrit Poetics*- Krishna Chaitanya
4. *Sanskrit Poetics* S.K.Dey
5. *Sanskrit Poetics*- P.V.Kane
6. *Kavyameemamsa* Rajasekhara.
7. The Bloomsbury Research Handbook of Indian Aesthetics and Philosophy of Art - Arindam Chakrabarti.
8. Harvard Series- Volume 9 forty-Nine Orientals Edited by Gary A. Tubb
9. *Natyashastra*- Bharata Muni
10. *The Art and Thought of Indian Literature*- Sheldon Pollock
11. *Indian Aesthetics*- Ananda K.
12. *Kavyadarsha*- Dandin
13. *Locana* - Abhinavagupta
14. *Kavya Candrika*-Vagbhata
15. *History of Indian Literature*- Krishnamacharya Veluthat
16. *Vakrokti Jivita*- Kuntaka
17. A study of Stylistics in
18. Sanskrit poetics (Special reference to Kuntaka)- T.Vasudevan, Calicut University

Mapping of COs with PSOs and Pos:

	PSO 1	PSO 2	PSO 3	PSO 4	PSO 5	PSO 6	PO 1	PO 2	PO 3	PO 4	PO 5	PO 6	PO 7
CO 1	1	3	3	2	3	2	3	1	2	3	2	3	2
CO 2	3	2	3	2	2	1	3	3	2	3	2	3	2
CO 3	2	2	3	2	3	3	3	1	2	3	3	2	3
CO 4	3	2	3	3	1	1	2	3	2	3	3	1	2
CO 5	2	3	3	2	3	2	3	3	3	3	3	1	2
CO 6	2	3	1	2	3	3	3	2	1	2	3	3	3

Correlation levels:

Level	Correlation
-	Nil
1	Slightly / Low
2	Moderate / Medium
3	Substantial / High

Assessment Rubrics:

- Assignment/ Discussion / Seminar
- Midterm Exam
- Class Tests/Quiz
- Final Exam (70%)

Mapping of COs to Assessment Rubrics:

	Internal Exam	Assignment	Project Evaluation	End Semester Examinations
CO 1	✓	✓		✓
CO 2	✓	✓		✓
CO 3		✓		✓
CO 4		✓	✓	✓
CO 5	✓	✓	✓	✓
CO6		✓	✓	